

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Extract (1): *"The whole world with its lands and seas, its cities and villages - was nothing but a big rattrap. It had never existed for any other purpose than to set baits for people. It offered riches and joys, shelter and food, heat and clothing, exactly as the rattrap offered cheese and pork, and as soon as anyone let himself be tempted to touch the bait, it closed in on him, and then everything came to an end."*

☐ Questions

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1: What does the metaphor of the rattrap signify in the passage?

- (a) The interconnectedness of life
- (b) The trap of material benefits
- (c) The beauty of nature
- (d) The simplicity of human existence **Answer:** (b) The trap of material benefits

Q2: Why did the peddler enjoy thinking of the world as a rattrap?

- (a) It gave him joy to think ill of the world
- (b) He wanted to escape his monotonous life
- (c) He wanted to warn others about the dangers of materialism
- (d) He was inspired by the kindness of others **Answer:** (a) It gave him joy to think ill of the world

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions

Q3: Assertion: The peddler believed the world was a rattrap that tempted people with material benefits. **Reason:** He thought this way because he had experienced the harshness of life and the indifference of the world.

- (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

(b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

(c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

(d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

Q4: Assertion: The peddler was tempted by the thirty kronor and stole it from the crofter.

Reason: He believed that material wealth was the only way to escape his miserable life.

(a) Both Assertion and Reason are true, and Reason is the correct explanation of Assertion.

(b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

(c) Assertion is true, but Reason is false.

(d) Assertion is false, but Reason is true. **Answer:** (b) Both Assertion and Reason are true, but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.

3. Fill in the Blanks

Q5: The peddler thought of the world as a _____, offering bait in the form of riches and joys, shelter and food. **Answer:** rattrap

4. Choose the Words and Pick the Right Choice

Q6: Which word best describes the peddler's attitude towards the world in the passage?

- (a) Optimistic
- (b) Cynical
- (c) Grateful
- (d) Indifferent **Answer:** (b) Cynical

Extract 2

"But just as he laid his head on the ground, he heard a sound—a hard regular thumping. There was no doubt as to what that was. He raised himself. 'Those are the hammer strokes from an iron mill,' he thought. 'There must be people nearby.' He summoned all his strength, got up, and staggered in the direction of the sound."

☐ Questions with Answers and Marking Scheme

1. **MCQ:** What gave the peddler hope when he thought all was lost?

(a) A bright star (b) A dog barking (c) Hammer strokes from the mill (d) A distant voice

☐ Answer: (c) Hammer strokes from the mill

2. **MCQ:** Why did the peddler stagger toward the sound?

(a) He wanted to steal (b) He hoped to find warmth and people (c) He wanted a job (d) He feared getting arrested

☐ Answer: (b) He hoped to find warmth and people

3. **Assertion–Reason: Assertion (A):** The peddler entered the forge to find shelter. **Reason (R):** He was drawn by the glow and sound of the furnace.

☐ Answer: (a) Both A and R are true, and R explains A

4. **Assertion–Reason: Assertion (A):** The forest felt like an impenetrable prison to the peddler. **Reason (R):** He believed he had fallen into a trap like others tempted by riches.

☐ Answer: (a) Both A and R are true, and R explains A

5. **Choose the word:** Which word describes his movement after hearing the sound? (a) Strolled (b) Dashed (c) Staggered (d) Tiptoe

☐ Answer: (c) Staggered

☐ **Extract 3**

“This whole world is nothing but a big rattrap. All the good things that are offered to you are nothing but cheese rinds and bits of pork set out to drag a poor fellow into trouble.”

☐ **Questions with Answers and Marking Scheme (5 × 2 marks)**

1. **MCQ:** What metaphor does the peddler use to describe the world?

(a) A game of cards (b) A trap of temptation (c) A battlefield (d) A forest maze

Answer: (b) A trap of temptation

2. **MCQ:** According to the peddler, what do “cheese rinds and bits of pork” symbolise?

(a) Material temptations (b) Food offered by crofter (c) Poverty (d) His merchandise

Answer: (a) Material temptations

3. **Assertion–Reason: Assertion (A):** The peddler believed he was caught in the world's rattrap. **Reason (R):** He had succumbed to temptation by stealing the crofter's money.

☐ Answer: (a) Both A and R are true, and R explains A

4. **Assertion–Reason: Assertion (A):** The peddler defended himself by calling the world a rattrap. **Reason (R):** He wanted to justify his crime and avoid punishment.

☐ Answer: (b) Both A and R are true, but R does not fully explain A

5. **Choose the word:** Pick the synonym of "temptation" in context.

(a) Pursuit (b) Bait (c) Luxury (d) Freedom ☐ Answer: (b) Bait

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

Marking Scheme: ✓ ☐ Factual accuracy – 1 mark ✓ ☐ Explanation / relevance – 1 mark

☐ Story-Based (3 Questions × 2 Marks)

1. **Why did the peddler return the stolen money?**

☐ After experiencing Edla's compassion and hospitality, the peddler had a change of heart. Her kindness awakened his conscience, leading him to return the thirty kronor and leave a rattrap as a symbolic gift.

2. **What role does Edla play in transforming the peddler?**

☐ Edla treats the peddler with empathy and dignity, even after knowing the truth about him. Her unconditional generosity makes him feel valued, prompting him to reform.

3. **How is the ending of the story unexpected yet satisfying?**

☐ The story ends with the peddler leaving a gift and a letter, expressing gratitude and redemption. Despite his past, he chooses honesty, surprising readers and completing his transformation.

☐ Value-Based Questions (3 Questions × 2 Marks)

1. **What human value is reinforced when Edla insists the peddler stay for Christmas?**

☐ Compassion and forgiveness. Edla believes every human deserves dignity, even a vagabond, reinforcing acceptance and empathy.

2. **How does the story reflect the need for human connection?**

☐ The crofter's friendliness and Edla's kindness both stem from loneliness. The story shows how companionship can heal and redeem.

3. **How does the peddler's transformation convey hope?**

☐ It proves that even flawed individuals can change when shown love and trust, offering hope for humanity's inherent goodness.

☐ Competency-Based Questions (4 Questions × 2 Marks)

1. Link the metaphor of the rattrap to human greed.

☐ The rattrap symbolizes the bait of materialism. Just as mice get caught, humans chasing wealth often fall into trouble.

2. How does irony enhance the impact of the story's ending?

☐ Irony lies in a thief becoming a benefactor. This reversal challenges our judgment and celebrates human transformation.

3. What message does the story convey about societal rejection?

☐ Those society discards can still possess moral worth. The peddler's redemption proves empathy can restore dignity.

4. Connect the story to the theme of Christmas.

☐ The story aligns with Christmas values—forgiveness, generosity, and moral rebirth—making the peddler's change symbolic of spiritual awakening.

☐ Literary Device-Based Questions (2 Questions × 2 Marks)

1. Identify and explain the metaphor used in the story.

☐ The entire world is described as a “rattrap,” which reflects how material temptations can trap people. It symbolises the human tendency toward greed.

2. What is the effect of irony in the peddler's final act?

☐ The irony lies in a thief returning stolen money with a gift. It adds emotional depth and highlights the unpredictability of human nature.

Section C: Long Answer Questions

1. Theme-Based Question

Q: What is the central theme of 'The Rattrap'? Marking Scheme:

- Introduction – 1 mark
- Content Para 1 – 1.5 marks
- Content Para 2 – 1.5 marks
- Conclusion – 1 mark

Answer The central theme of “The Rattrap” is the metaphorical trap of materialism that entangles human beings and the power of compassion to redeem even the most morally lost individuals.

The story revolves around a poor peddler who believes that the world is a giant rattrap meant to deceive people with temptations like wealth and comfort. This idea comforts him and justifies his petty thefts. His own fall into temptation—stealing thirty kronor from the crofter—is a literal representation of being caught in the rattrap.

However, the kindness shown by Edla Willmansson transforms him. Despite knowing his truth, she treats him with dignity. This act of unconditional compassion awakens the peddler’s conscience and leads him to return the stolen money. Through this change, the story reveals the redemptive power of empathy and trust.

The metaphor of the rattrap powerfully underscores how material desires imprison people—but also how human kindness can offer a way out.

2. Value-Based Question

Q: What human values are highlighted through Edla’s actions in the story? Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer Edla Willmansson embodies values like empathy, kindness, respect for human dignity, and moral courage, which play a crucial role in the peddler's transformation.

When the ironmaster invites the tramp home, Edla treats him with gentle compassion. Even after discovering that he is not a captain, she insists he stay and enjoy Christmas. Her approach is free from judgment, inspired by an instinct to extend humanity toward someone who seems lost and neglected.

Edla’s quiet strength and moral conviction reflect an understanding that every person—no matter how broken—deserves to feel valued. Her gesture not only surprises the peddler but forces him to reconsider his choices. This generosity ultimately leads him to return the stolen money, leaving behind a gift and a letter of gratitude.

Through Edla’s actions, the story highlights that compassion and faith in others have the power to heal and rehabilitate. It teaches that kindness shown without expectation can create ripples of change.

3. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on 'Redemption through Compassion: Lessons from The Rattrap'. Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer In an increasingly materialistic world, Selma Lagerlöf's "The Rattrap" offers a timeless lesson: compassion is the key to redemption.

The story's protagonist is a downtrodden peddler who views the world cynically—as a giant trap baited with wealth and comfort. When he steals money from a kind crofter, it seems he has proven his own theory. But fate takes a turn when he meets Edla Willmansson.

Edla's choice to treat him with respect, even after discovering his true identity, surprises him. Her genuine warmth prompts deep self-reflection. For the first time, he feels seen—not judged. This shifts his mindset, and he returns the stolen money with a note, calling himself "Captain von Stahle." That symbolic gesture signifies his moral rebirth.

In the end, the story shows that empathy can change hearts more effectively than punishment or preaching. Compassion is not weakness—it's transformative strength.

4. Speech-Based Question

Q: As Edla Willmansson, deliver a speech on how kindness changed a stranger's life.

Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer Good morning respected teachers and friends.

I want to share how one act of kindness changed not just a stranger—but me.

It was Christmas Eve when my father brought home a man mistaken for his old friend. He looked poor and frightened. After learning he was just a peddler, Father wanted him gone. But I saw something in his eyes—exhaustion, sadness, and a need to be trusted.

I begged Father to let him stay. We gave him food, warmth, and dignity. The next morning, we discovered he had returned stolen money from an old crofter. He left a note, thanking us and calling himself "Captain von Stahle." That man, once wrapped in suspicion and guilt, left transformed.

What I learned is simple: kindness is powerful. It can restore trust, awaken conscience, and change lives. Let us never hesitate to extend it—even to strangers.

Thank you.

5. Story-Based Question

Q: Retell the story of 'The Rattrap' in your own words, highlighting the peddler's transformation. Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer The story follows a poor peddler who sells rattraps. Disillusioned with life, he compares the world to a giant trap that lures people with material bait.

One day, he steals money from a kind crofter and hides in the forest, feeling trapped himself. He stumbles into an iron mill and is mistaken for an old regimental friend by the ironmaster. Although he tries to leave, the ironmaster's daughter, Edla, persuades him to stay.

Her kindness moves him deeply. She treats him like a guest, offering warmth and dignity without judgment. The next morning, he quietly leaves the house but leaves behind a gift—a rattrap containing the stolen money and a note thanking her. He signs it “Captain von Stahle,” symbolizing his rebirth.

The story shows how trust and compassion can transform even the most cynical hearts.

☐ 6. Author's Point of View Question

Q: What message does Selma Lagerlöf convey about human nature in 'The Rattrap'?

Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer Selma Lagerlöf conveys that every human being possesses innate goodness, which can be awakened through love and understanding. She explores the duality of human nature—the capacity for both wrongdoing and redemption.

The story's protagonist begins as a thief who justifies his actions by believing that the world is a trap. However, when he meets Edla, her kindness challenges his beliefs. Rather than being punished, he is welcomed and respected, which triggers an emotional and moral shift in him.

Lagerlöf's point is clear: trust and compassion often succeed where laws and authority fail. She wants readers to understand that moral failures do not define a person permanently. Given the right circumstances, transformation is always possible.

Through her fairy-tale style, Lagerlöf gently nudges us toward empathy and hope for humankind.

☐ 7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Q: Write a diary entry from the peddler's perspective after leaving Ramsjö manor.

Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer 25th December Dear Diary,

Today, I became someone new.

Last night, I slept under a warm roof, wore fine clothes, and ate like a human being again. Miss Edla—an angel, really—welcomed me despite knowing my truth. She gave me peace, warmth, and something I hadn't felt in years—respect.

She didn't ask anything in return. She just believed in me.

So, I left the thirty kronor I stole. That old crofter deserves honesty. I shaped a rattrap as a gift and wrote a note to Edla. I even called myself Captain von Stahle—not because I deserved the title, but because she made me feel like I could.

I'm walking again, back into the cold, but something in me is warm and alive. This is the beginning of my change.

Gratefully, Captain von Stahle